

Marnie the Mole Hears the Stars

An original bedtime story for ages 4–7. Reading time: about 4 minutes.



Kids Book Videos



Marnie was a small velvet mole. She lived in tunnels under the meadow. Marnie had tiny eyes. She could barely see at all. She felt the world with her nose. Sniff sniff. She felt it with her whiskers. Tickle tickle. One evening, Marnie popped out of her tunnel. Her friend Junie the junco bird was singing on a branch. "Oh, the stars are beautiful tonight!" chirped Junie. Marnie looked up. She saw only blurry dots. Her heart sank. "I cannot see the stars," she whispered. She felt sad. Everyone loved the stars but her. She felt left out.



Junie fluttered down beside her. "Do not feel sad, Marnie," said Junie. "You can hear the stars instead." Marnie tilted her head. "Hear them?" she asked. "Stars do not make sounds." Junie smiled. "Close your eyes and listen," she said. "Stars sing, even when you cannot see." "Stars sing, even when you cannot see." Marnie repeated it softly. "Stars sing, even when you cannot see." It became their nighttime song. "Stars sing, even when you cannot see."



Marnie closed her eyes. She listened very hard. First, she heard the crickets. Chirp chirp chirp. "That is the stars tuning up," whispered Junie. Then she heard the breeze. Shhh shhh shhh. "That is the stars dancing," said Junie. Then she heard an owl. Hoo hoo. "That is the stars saying goodnight," said Junie. Marnie smiled. She could hear the whole sky. It was beautiful. She felt included. She felt peaceful. Her ears showed her the stars.



Can you hear the stars like Marnie? Close your eyes. Listen. What do you hear? Chirp? Shhh? The stars are singing for you too. Marnie and Junie sat together all evening. Junie described the constellations. "That one looks like a bear," she chirped. Marnie imagined it. She painted pictures in her mind. Big bright bears. Twinkling teapots. The night felt magical. Marnie did not need to see. She could hear and imagine.



When the moon was high, Marnie felt sleepy. She curled in the soft grass. Junie tucked under a leaf nearby. "Goodnight, star listener," chirped Junie. "Goodnight," yawned Marnie. She heard the crickets one last time. Chirp... chirp... chirp. The stars sang her to sleep. Twinkle, shhh, twinkle. And Marnie slept under the singing sky.

Moral: *There is more than one way to enjoy something beautiful.*

The End